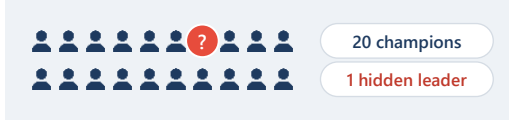
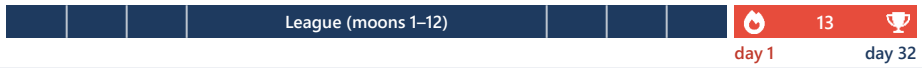
Lumen's real problem is belonging.

We give every Lumenite a shared past, a shared place and a shared weekly rhythm

> WHAT WE SEE
> People finish work and go home alone. Gatherings are empty. Life is *"functional but empty"*

	THE GAP	OUR DESIGN	HOW IT WORKS	WHY IT WORKS
1	WHY **No shared past** (no history) SO **the family, across time**	TRADITION **The Four Letters** *A shared past* 	• Every Lumenite writes four letters in a life, each at home with the household gathered, on the day they reach that age. • Letters 1–3 stay sealed. At 250 you open them, read your life back, and write the fourth. • The 250 letter is for your children and theirs, kept with your photo as the family's record of who you were. • After death, the letters go to the Lumen Archive, open to any future Lumenite if the writer allowed it while alive. • In Year 1, the ~8,300 Lumenites already past 250 write first, so history starts on day one.	**Belonging:** every family gains a written past, and the Archive grows into the whole planet's shared history. **Only on Lumen:** a 300-year life lets you open your own letters 225 years after the first.
2	WHY **No shared place** (nothing smaller than a city of 50,000 to belong to) SO **the district, once a year**	FESTIVAL **The Carrying** *A shared place · Day 1 of the 13th moon* 	• Each of the 100 districts carries one flame to every home it has: ~125 homes, door to door from first light. • Every household adds what fuel it can. Fuel is precious gas, so each home gives part of its wealth. • At dusk the flame is set in the district square for all 500 to see. It burns through the night for as long as the district's gift lasts.	**Belonging:** the flame exists only because every door gave. Fire stands for hope and togetherness. **Only on Lumen:** the fuel is the currency itself, and a 15-hour night gives the flame its stage.
3	WHY **No shared rhythm** (nothing to look forward to, so work fills the time) SO **the whole planet, every week**	ENTERTAINMENT **The Hidden Head League** *A shared rhythm · Every week* 	• Each season, every district draws 20 champions by lot; one is secretly the leader. • Each week the districts play in pairs (50 matches). Each round, the hidden leader quietly steers their side through a task; the other side watches who the players follow and names one suspect. A wrong name clears that suspect and costs the next guess; the first side to name the other's leader wins. • Moons 1–12 are the league; in the 13th moon the top 16 play a knockout, with the final on the last night of the year. • Spectators bet in gas on the leader: the earlier the bet, the bigger the payout (up to 20× in round 1, falling as suspects are cleared). Stakes are capped; the house cut pays the champion district's prize.	**Belonging:** a weekly reason to leave work and stand with your district. Every adult plays about 12 seasons in a life. **Only on Lumen:** the planet's real leader is secret, so its favourite game is finding one.

ONE LUMEN YEAR The 13th moon is Lumen's high season: it opens with the Carrying (day 1) and closes with the league final (day 32).



KEY ASSUMPTIONS 1 Ages are in Lumen years (50 = Earth 18, so 25 ≈ Earth 9). 2 The moon cycle is 32 days, giving 13 moons a year (13 × 32 = 416 days). A week is 8 days, giving 52 weeks. 3 There are 100 districts of 500 people, with ~4 per home, so ~125 homes each. 4 Precious gases also burn as fuel, so fuel is money. 5 Ages are spread evenly, about 167 people per birth-year, so ~8,300 people are already past 250. 6 Open-air squares hold a whole district. The 1,000-seat Hall hosts the playoffs. 7 Betting is legal (the economy is capitalist), with a cap per person.